

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

The musical score is written for a single voice in treble clef, with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#) and a 4/4 time signature. The melody is simple and repetitive, consisting of eighth and quarter notes. The lyrics are arranged in four lines, each corresponding to a musical phrase. The first line includes a four-part setting of the first phrase. The second line is a single-part setting. The third line is a single-part setting with a long note for 'heart,'. The fourth line is a single-part setting ending with a double bar line.

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

In my heart, in my heart,

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.